A PLANNER & ACTIVITY BOOK

The Busy Family Planner

Meal Plans, Kids Routines, Cooking Together and Pet Care Pages for Families with Little Kids

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The Busy Family Planner
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Designed by our small shop, AureliaVenn, with the help of AI tools. The pet pages are a planning aid, not veterinary advice. The cooking pages are meant for cooking together with an adult; always check for allergies.

INSIDE THIS BOOK

Contents

Five small systems for a calmer family week. Use them in any order. Write in pencil if you want to reuse a page.

Meals & Groceries	Plan the week, write one grocery list, let your child pick a meal.
Cook With Me	Picture recipes your preschooler can follow, step by step.
Morning & Bedtime	Calm routines with picture steps for little ones.
Ready for a Dog?	A gentle family plan before saying yes to a dog.
Happy Indoor Cat	Play, rest and safe-home pages for the family cat.

How to use this book

Pick one section for this week. Fill it in together with your child at the kitchen table, then come back next week. Small steps, every week.



PART 1

Meals & Groceries

Plan the week, write one grocery list, let your child pick a meal.

EVERY WEEK

Weekly Meal Plan

WEEK OF

BUSY NIGHTS

DAY	BREAKFAST	LUNCH	DINNER	SNACK
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

SHOP ONCE

Grocery List by Aisle

Fruit & veggies

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

Dairy & eggs

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

Protein

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

Pantry & grains

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

Freezer

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

Kids' snacks & lunchbox

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

Home & other

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

Don't forget

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

FOR LITTLE HANDS

Kids' Menu Picker

Read the words together and let your child color one circle in each column. Write the picks into the weekly plan – and tell them it was their idea.

Pick a veggie	Pick a fruit	Pick a favorite
carrot	apple	pasta
cucumber	banana	rice
peas	berries	pancakes
broccoli	grapes	tacos
corn	pear	soup
pepper	orange	pizza
tomato	melon	eggs
_____	_____	_____

This week, our little chef chose...

WHEN YOU'RE STUCK

20 Easy Family Dinners

Tick the ones your family loves. On a busy night, just pick the next tick.

- [ ] **Sheet-pan chicken & veggies**
  ONE PAN · 35 MIN
- [ ] **Turkey taco bowls**
  KID BUILDS OWN
- [ ] **Veggie pasta bake**
  FREEZER-FRIENDLY
- [ ] **Salmon, rice & peas**
  25 MIN
- [ ] **Bean & cheese quesadillas**
  MEATLESS
- [ ] **Mini meatballs & tomato sauce**
  BATCH COOK
- [ ] **Egg fried rice**
  USES LEFTOVERS
- [ ] **Lentil & carrot soup**
  SLOW COOKER
- [ ] **Homemade pizza night**
  KID TOPS OWN
- [ ] **Chicken noodle soup**
  COZY
- [ ] **Breakfast for dinner**
  PANCAKES & FRUIT
- [ ] **Fish tacos & slaw**
  20 MIN
- [ ] **Baked potato bar**
  TOPPINGS BUFFET
- [ ] **Teriyaki tofu & broccoli**
  MEATLESS
- [ ] **Turkey burgers & sweet potato**
  GRILL OR OVEN
- [ ] **Pesto pasta with peas**
  15 MIN
- [ ] **Chili with beans**
  BIG BATCH
- [ ] **Hummus wrap night**
  NO COOK
- [ ] **Shepherd's pie**
  MAKE AHEAD
- [ ] **Leftover remix night**
  ZERO WASTE

ONE HOUR ON SUNDAY

Sunday Prep Checklist

- [ ] Check the calendar: busy nights = quick meals
- [ ] Ask everyone for one wish meal
- [ ] Write the plan and the grocery list
- [ ] Wash & cut veggies for 3 days
- [ ] Cook a big batch of rice or pasta
- [ ] Portion snacks into grab-and-go boxes
- [ ] Prep overnight oats for 2 mornings
- [ ] Defrost Monday's protein
- [ ] Clear one fridge shelf for leftovers
- [ ] Pin the plan on the fridge

LEFTOVERS TO USE FIRST

NEXT WEEK I'D LIKE TO TRY



PART 2

Cook With Me

Picture recipes your preschooler can follow, step by step.

RECIPE CARDS 1-4

Let's cook!

Rainbow Fruit Skewers

No. 01

about 10 min

LITTLE CHEF JOBS

1. Wash the fruit
2. Count 6 pieces
3. Slide fruit on a stick

YOU NEED

- strawberries
- melon
- kiwi
- grapes, quartered
- blueberries

Grown-up: Cut fruit, use blunt sticks

OUR NOTES

DID WE LIKE IT?

Banana Oat Cookies

No. 02

about 25 min

LITTLE CHEF JOBS

1. Mash 2 bananas
2. Stir in the oats
3. Roll little balls

YOU NEED

- 2 ripe bananas
- 1 cup oats
- a handful of raisins

Grown-up: Oven 350°F / 175°C, 12 min

OUR NOTES

DID WE LIKE IT?

Berry Yogurt Bark

No. 03

about 15 min

LITTLE CHEF JOBS

1. Spread the yogurt
2. Sprinkle berries
3. Wait for the freezer

YOU NEED

- 2 cups plain yogurt
- 1 tsp honey (1 yr+)
- mixed berries

Grown-up: Freeze 2 hours, break pieces

OUR NOTES

DID WE LIKE IT?

Veggie Face Toast

No. 04

about 10 min

LITTLE CHEF JOBS

1. Spread the cream cheese
2. Make eyes and a smile
3. Count the veggie pieces

YOU NEED

- whole-grain toast
- cream cheese
- cucumber, pepper, carrot

Grown-up: Toast bread, slice veggies

OUR NOTES

DID WE LIKE IT?

RECIPE CARDS 5-8

Let's cook!

Mini Pita Pizzas

No. 05

about 20 min

LITTLE CHEF JOBS

1. Spread the sauce
2. Sprinkle the cheese
3. Add a veggie topping

YOU NEED

- mini pitas
- tomato sauce
- mozzarella
- sweetcorn, spinach

Grown-up: Oven 400°F / 200°C, 8 min

OUR NOTES

DID WE LIKE IT?

Sunny Smoothie Bowl

No. 06

about 10 min

LITTLE CHEF JOBS

1. Pour into the blender
2. Press the button with help
3. Add toppings

YOU NEED

- 1 frozen banana
- 1/2 cup mango
- 1/2 cup yogurt
- oats, berries

Grown-up: Blend, check temperature

OUR NOTES

DID WE LIKE IT?

Cucumber Sandwich Bites

No. 07

about 10 min

LITTLE CHEF JOBS

1. Spread the butter
2. Stack the layers
3. Cut shapes with a cutter

YOU NEED

- whole-grain bread
- butter
- cucumber
- dill (optional)

Grown-up: Slice cucumber thinly

OUR NOTES

DID WE LIKE IT?

Overnight Oats Jar

No. 08

about 10 min

LITTLE CHEF JOBS

1. Pour the milk
2. Stir it all up
3. Top with fruit

YOU NEED

- 1/2 cup oats
- 1/2 cup milk
- 2 tbsp yogurt
- berries

Grown-up: Fridge overnight

OUR NOTES

DID WE LIKE IT?

RECIPE CARDS 9-12

Let's cook!

Apple Donuts

No. 09

about 10 min

LITTLE CHEF JOBS

1. Spread the yogurt
2. Add sprinkles of seeds
3. Count the rings

YOU NEED

- 1 apple
- yogurt or nut butter
- hemp seeds, coconut

Grown-up: Core and slice the apple

OUR NOTES

DID WE LIKE IT?

Hummus Rainbow Plate

No. 10

about 10 min

LITTLE CHEF JOBS

1. Wash the veggies
2. Sort by color
3. Dip and taste

YOU NEED

- hummus
- carrot
- pepper
- cucumber
- snap peas

Grown-up: Cut veggie sticks

OUR NOTES

DID WE LIKE IT?

Banana Sushi

No. 11

about 10 min

LITTLE CHEF JOBS

1. Spread the butter
2. Roll it up tight
3. Count the slices

YOU NEED

- 1 tortilla
- sunflower or nut butter
- 1 banana

Grown-up: Slice into rounds

OUR NOTES

DID WE LIKE IT?

Frozen Yogurt Drops

No. 12

about 10 min

LITTLE CHEF JOBS

1. Spoon yogurt into a bag
2. Squeeze little drops
3. Wait for the freezer

YOU NEED

- 1 cup yogurt
- 1 tbsp berry puree

Grown-up: Snip the bag corner, freeze 2 h

OUR NOTES

DID WE LIKE IT?

RECIPE CARDS 13-16

Let's cook!

Muffin Tin Egg Bites

No. 13

about 30 min

LITTLE CHEF JOBS

1. Crack the eggs (with help)
2. Whisk, whisk, whisk
3. Add veggies to each cup

YOU NEED

- 6 eggs
- spinach
- pepper
- cheese

Grown-up: Oven 350°F / 175°C, 18 min

OUR NOTES

DID WE LIKE IT?

Pick & Mix Snack Cups

No. 14

about 5 min

LITTLE CHEF JOBS

1. Sort into bowls
2. Count 5 of each
3. Pour into a cup

YOU NEED

- whole-grain cereal
- pumpkin seeds
- dried apple
- popped sorghum

Grown-up: Choose age-safe pieces

OUR NOTES

DID WE LIKE IT?

Berry Chia Jam

No. 15

about 15 min

LITTLE CHEF JOBS

1. Mash the berries
2. Stir in chia seeds
3. Wait 20 minutes

YOU NEED

- 2 cups berries
- 2 tbsp chia seeds
- 1 tsp lemon juice

Grown-up: Warm berries gently

OUR NOTES

DID WE LIKE IT?

Quesadilla Triangles

No. 16

about 15 min

LITTLE CHEF JOBS

1. Sprinkle the cheese
2. Spread the beans
3. Count the triangles

YOU NEED

- 2 tortillas
- cheese
- black beans
- sweetcorn

Grown-up: Cook in a pan, cut

OUR NOTES

DID WE LIKE IT?

RECIPE CARDS 17-20

Let's cook!

Pancake Faces

No. 17

about 25 min

LITTLE CHEF JOBS

1. Pour the milk
2. Stir the batter
3. Make a fruit face

YOU NEED

- 1 cup flour
- 1 egg
- 1 cup milk
- fruit for faces

Grown-up: Cook pancakes at the stove

OUR NOTES

DID WE LIKE IT?

Frozen Banana Pops

No. 18

about 15 min

LITTLE CHEF JOBS

1. Dip in yogurt
2. Roll in toppings
3. Wait for the freezer

YOU NEED

- 2 bananas
- yogurt
- crushed cereal

Grown-up: Cut bananas, add sticks

OUR NOTES

DID WE LIKE IT?

Mash-It Guacamole

No. 19

about 10 min

LITTLE CHEF JOBS

1. Mash the avocado
2. Squeeze the lime
3. Stir and taste

YOU NEED

- 2 avocados
- 1/2 lime
- 1 small tomato
- pinch of salt

Grown-up: Halve avocado, chop tomato

OUR NOTES

DID WE LIKE IT?

Cinnamon Apple Cups

No. 20

about 20 min

LITTLE CHEF JOBS

1. Wash the apples
2. Sprinkle cinnamon
3. Stir the oats on top

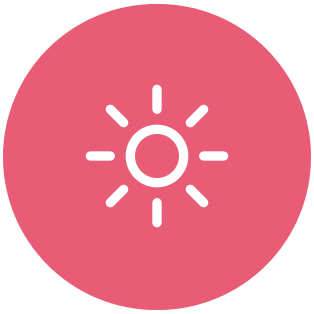
YOU NEED

- 2 apples
- cinnamon
- 2 tbsp oats
- yogurt to serve

Grown-up: Chop apples, microwave 3 min

OUR NOTES

DID WE LIKE IT?



PART 3

Morning & Bedtime

Calm routines with picture steps for little ones.

EVERY MORNING

Morning Routine Chart

NAME

WEEK OF

THIS MORNING I...	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Wake up & smile	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Potty & wash hands	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Get dressed	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Eat breakfast	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Brush teeth	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Hair & face	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Shoes & jacket on	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Hug & go!	○	○	○	○	○	○	○

EVERY EVENING

Bedtime Routine Chart

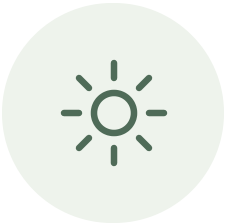
NAME

WEEK OF

TONIGHT I...	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Tidy up toys	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Bath time	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Pajamas on	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Brush teeth	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Potty & wash hands	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Story time	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Hugs & kisses	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Lights out	○	○	○	○	○	○	○

CUT ALONG THE DASHED LINES

Morning Picture Cards



Wake up & smile



Potty & wash hands



Get dressed



Eat breakfast



Brush teeth



Hair & face



Shoes & jacket on



Hug & go!



Water the plants



Feed the cat



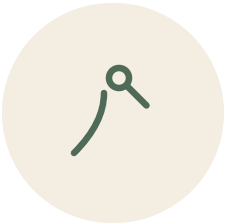
Help set the table



Quiet play

CUT ALONG THE DASHED LINES

Bedtime Picture Cards



Tidy up toys



Bath time



Pajamas on



Brush teeth



Potty & wash hands



Story time



Hugs & kisses



Lights out



Look at today's plan



Say something kind



Healthy snack



Calm breathing

COLLECT THE STARS

I Did It! Reward Chart

Color one star for each routine your child finished. Two weeks, morning and bedtime.

Week 1 · Morning



Mon Tue Wed Thu Fri Sat Sun

Week 1 · Bedtime



Mon Tue Wed Thu Fri Sat Sun

Week 2 · Morning



Mon Tue Wed Thu Fri Sat Sun

Week 2 · Bedtime



Mon Tue Wed Thu Fri Sat Sun

MY REWARD FOR 7 STARS

MY REWARD FOR 14 STARS



PART 4

Ready for a Dog?

A gentle family plan before saying yes to a dog.

WEEK 1 · TALK & CHECK

Family Readiness Checklist

Tick what is already true. Every open box is something to plan for, not a reason to feel bad.

Our home

- [ ] Our lease / building allows dogs
- [ ] Safe outdoor spot or a park nearby
- [ ] A quiet corner for a dog bed
- [ ] Cat has high places & a dog-free room
- [ ] Toys and food can be kept off the floor

Our time

- [ ] 2–3 walks a day fit our schedule
- [ ] Someone is home or a walker is possible
- [ ] We can do weekly training for 3 months
- [ ] Holiday plan: family, sitter or boarding
- [ ] The adults agree who does mornings

Our money

- [ ] Monthly budget filled in (next page)
- [ ] Emergency vet savings or insurance
- [ ] Start-up costs saved (bed, crate, vet)

Our family

- [ ] No one in the home has a dog allergy
- [ ] Our child can follow 2 simple dog rules
- [ ] We talked about which size suits us

Our decision today

- [ ] Yes, let's prepare
- [ ] Not yet — check again on _____

WEEK 1 · DO THE MONEY

Monthly Dog Budget

Write your local prices. Add the start-up costs once, then the monthly lines. Ask your vet for a typical yearly cost in your area.

START-UP (ONE TIME)	ESTIMATE	ACTUAL
Adoption / breeder fee		
First vet visit, vaccines, microchip		
Crate, bed, bowls, leash, harness		
Baby gate (keeps the cat's space safe)		
Puppy / obedience class		
Start-up total		

EVERY MONTH	ESTIMATE	ACTUAL
Food & treats		
Insurance or vet savings		
Flea, tick & worm prevention		
Grooming		
Dog walker / daycare		
Toys, poop bags, extras		
Monthly total		

WE CAN COMFORTABLY SPEND PER MONTH

DIFFERENCE (COMFORTABLE – MONTHLY TOTAL)

WEEKS 1-4 · FOR LITTLE HANDS

Little Helper Chart

Practise with your cat or a plush dog. Your child adds a sticker or a colored dot for every job done. Pictures help pre-readers.

JOB	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Fill the food bowl							
Fresh water							
Gentle brushing							
Play for 10 minutes							
Tidy toys away							
Quiet time: let pet rest							

WEEK OF

OUR REWARD WHEN THE CHART IS FULL

WEEKS 1-4 · ONE TINY TASK A DAY

30-Day Practice Challenge

Read the task together, do it, color the circle. Grown-ups help with the reading; kids do the doing.

DAY 1 Draw your dream dog	DAY 2 Feed the cat with a grown-up	DAY 3 Learn: let a sleeping pet sleep	DAY 4 Walk the plush dog around the block	DAY 5 Fill the water bowl alone
DAY 6 Pick 3 dog names	DAY 7 Visit a dog-friendly park	DAY 8 Learn: ask before you pet	DAY 9 Brush the cat gently	DAY 10 Tidy toys off the floor
DAY 11 Read a dog picture book	DAY 12 Play "sit & wait" with family	DAY 13 Feed the cat on time, morning	DAY 14 Say hi to a friend's calm dog	DAY 15 Halfway! Show a grown-up your chart
DAY 16 Learn: dogs need quiet corners	DAY 17 Practice a rainy-day walk	DAY 18 Make a "dog bed" spot plan	DAY 19 Play 10 min with the cat	DAY 20 Learn: no hugging a dog's neck
DAY 21 Help sort groceries for pets	DAY 22 Draw where the cat can hide	DAY 23 Early-morning "walk" at 7:00	DAY 24 Clean the food bowl together	DAY 25 Learn 3 dog body-language signs
DAY 26 Visit a pet shop, just look	DAY 27 Feed the cat on time, evening	DAY 28 Tell the family a dog rule	DAY 29 Look at the budget together	DAY 30 Sign Our Dog Promise!

WHEN YOU DECIDE YES

Cat & Dog Introduction Plan

Go slowly. Move to the next step only when both pets are relaxed. Many introductions take two to four weeks.

BEFORE **Prep**	Set up a dog-free room for the cat (food, water, litter, bed). Add shelves or a cat tree. Fit a baby gate. Ask the shelter if the dog has lived with cats.
DAYS 1-3 **Smell**	Keep them apart. Swap a blanket between rooms so they learn each other's scent. Feed both near the closed door.
DAYS 4-7 **See**	Short look-only sessions through the baby gate, dog on a leash, treats for calm behaviour. Stop before anyone gets stressed.
WEEK 2 **Share**	Leashed dog in the same room, cat free to leave and climb high. Five minutes, twice a day. Lots of praise.
WEEK 3+ **Live**	Supervised time together. The cat's room stays dog-free for good. Never leave them alone together until you are sure.

Our notes & progress



PART 5

Happy Indoor Cat

Play, rest and safe-home pages for the family cat.

GET TO KNOW YOUR CAT

Cat Profile

NAME

BIRTHDAY / GOTCHA DAY

VET & PHONE

photo or drawing

Favorite toys

Does NOT like

Favorite treats

Best nap spots

Funny habits & little quirks

TWO WEEKS AT A GLANCE

Play & Care Tracker

WEEK 1

DAILY	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Morning play	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Evening play	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Puzzle / hunt game	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Fresh water	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Litter scooped	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Brushing	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
New toy or scent	○	○	○	○	○	○	○

WEEK 2

DAILY	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Morning play	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Evening play	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Puzzle / hunt game	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Fresh water	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Litter scooped	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
Brushing	○	○	○	○	○	○	○
New toy or scent	○	○	○	○	○	○	○

TRY ONE A DAY

20 Enrichment Ideas

Tick the ones your cat loves. Most cost nothing but a cardboard box and five minutes.

- [ ] **Wand toy session**
  10 min, end with a 'catch'
- [ ] **Treat puzzle**
  egg carton or toilet-roll pyramid
- [ ] **Window perch**
  bird TV, safely latched
- [ ] **Cardboard box fort**
  cut two doorways
- [ ] **Paper bag tunnel**
  handles cut off
- [ ] **Hide & seek kibble**
  5 pieces around a room
- [ ] **Scent day**
  a new safe smell: a twig, a sock
- [ ] **Ping-pong ball in the bath**
  dry tub, endless chase
- [ ] **Scratching post upgrade**
  vertical and horizontal
- [ ] **Cat grass pot**
  grow it together
- [ ] **Shelf highway**
  a path up high
- [ ] **Clicker game**
  sit, high-five, come
- [ ] **Brushing spa**
  slow strokes, short sessions
- [ ] **Rotate the toys**
  hide half, swap weekly
- [ ] **Bubble chase**
  pet-safe bubbles
- [ ] **Food-dispensing ball**
  for breakfast
- [ ] **Crinkle blanket**
  under a towel
- [ ] **Sunny nap spot**
  a soft bed by the window
- [ ] **Bird feeder outside**
  visible from the window
- [ ] **Quiet hour**
  lights low, no chasing

FOR LITTLE HANDS, AGES 3+

Little Cat Helper

Read together, then let your child pick one job a day. Always with a grown-up nearby.

MY CAT JOBS

- Wiggle the wand toy slowly
- Fill the water bowl
- Gentle strokes, head and back
- Hide 3 treats for the cat
- Make a paper-ball toy
- Water the cat grass

GENTLE CAT RULES

- Let the cat come to you
- Sleeping cats are not for waking
- Cats need a quiet hiding place
- Tail flicking? Time to stop

TODAY I HELPED BY...

KEEP AN EYE ON THINGS

Weight & Vet Log

DATE	WEIGHT	VET / VACCINE / TREATMENT	NOTES

FOOD BRAND & DAILY AMOUNT

NEXT VET VISIT

NOTES

Family notes

NOTES

Family notes

NOTES

Family notes